of free electricity supply to farmers. The states would have to formulate a state-wide scheme accordingly and pilot it in one district by the end of the year. Kerala, Chhattisgarh and Goa implemented all four reforms availing maximum benefits for their people, whereas Maharashtra, Delhi and West Bengal failed to implement even one.

Several more measures across public and private sectors were announced in the next two tranches, providing a much-needed fiscal boost to reignite the economy.[4]

◆

19 MAY 2020

INDIA | 60,855 ACTIVE CASES | 3,311 DEATHS

WORLD | 25,11,431 ACTIVE CASES | 3,55,250 DEATHS

Meena Mukhiya (name changed) heard panicked noises as her husband Ravi Kumar Mukhiya rushed into their 100 sq. feet room in the Nehru Nagar chawl in Juhu. She shared the room with her husband Ravi, his two brothers and her two-year-old daughter. The brothers worked in temporary jobs as house help and cooks in upper middle-class homes in the posh JVPD suburb of Mumbai. After the lockdown was announced, all three brothers were asked to discontinue coming to work. For two months, they were paid their salaries; however, they had been forewarned by their respective employers that they should not expect to be receiving any more. Cash crunch had begun to hit even affluent households and coupled with the uncertainty of when businesses would function at pre-COVID-19 levels, they simply could not afford to keep their staff on payroll.

Lockdown had been hard. The five of them had to be cooped up inside the teeny room. The enforcement on movement restriction by the next-door Juhu Police Station had been very harsh, with folks unable to leave even the narrow lanes which housed their rooms. Entry and exit points to the Nehru Nagar Chawl were blocked by policemen carrying lathis, who didn't hesitate to use them. The family was paying ₹6,000 as room rent and with no income in sight, they had begun to grow increasingly frustrated and desperate to return to their village in Bihar, where the boys' parents had a big farm with a large self-built house. Over the years, the brothers had sent the savings to the parents in the village to build the family home. Her two-